works in Kudankulam, due to public protests, organised by non-governmental organisations (NGOs) with alleged US support.[7] The Russian perception was that the Indian government was succumbing to US pressure as payback for the decisive US role in securing the NSG waiver for India.

The extent of this drift in relations should not be exaggerated. India's dependence on Russian arms sales ensured that even when major projects did not progress as well as they might have, the annual volume still hovered around a not insignificant value of $2–3 billion. Annual summits ensure a scramble for deliverables every year, which helps to move stuck initiatives. More importantly, the drift did not dull sensitivity to core concerns. When Russia annexed Crimea in March 2014, India found a way to convey its understanding of the security concerns behind that action. In his telephone conversation with President Putin, Prime Minister Manmohan Singh drew attention to India's "consistent stand" on territorial integrity of nations but went on to express the hope that solutions would be found to protect the "legitimate interests of all countries in the region."[8] India's National Security Advisor went one step further, telling the media that there were "broader issues of reconciling various interests … legitimate Russian and other interests involved."[9] The government of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, which assumed office in May 2014, held the line. When asked by CNN's Fareed Zakaria about India's inadequate response to Russia's annexation of Crimea, Modi's response was essentially that he who has not sinned should cast the first stone.[10] In a speech to the Russian Parliament, President Putin expressed appreciation for India's "restraint and objectivity" in evaluating the Crimean developments.[11]

Rejuvenation: 2014